

INSIDE THE INDUSTRY

YOUR BUYERS THINK THIS MARKET FLIPPED. IT DIDN'T.

Inventory is still below what NAR calls a balanced market.

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**4.6 MONTHS OF
SUPPLY.
UNCHANGED FROM
A YEAR AGO.**

A balanced market needs five to six.

BUYERS ARE NEGOTIATING LIKE SELLERS LOST THEIR LEVERAGE. THE NUMBER SAYS THEY HAVEN'T.

NAR's July 2026 existing-home sales report, published August 11, 2026, put the median existing-home price at \$434,100, up 2.0 percent from a year earlier, with 4.6 months of supply, the exact same figure as one year before. NAR chief economist Lawrence Yun has said a genuinely balanced market runs five to six months of supply. A buyer holding out for October, expecting more room to negotiate, is negotiating against a market that never actually loosened.

SAY THIS THE NEXT TIME A BUYER SAYS "WE'LL WAIT":

- 1 Lead with the number, not the vibe.**
"Inventory is sitting at 4.6 months right now, the same as it was a year ago. That's not a market opening up."
- 2 Name the floor.**
"A balanced market runs five to six months of supply. We're still below that."
- 3 Reframe the wait.**
"Prices are still up 2 percent from last year. Waiting hasn't been the discount play."

THE TAKEAWAY

THE MARKET DIDN'T LOOSEN. YOUR BUYER'S ASSUMPTION DID.

Bring the number to the next consultation, not just the listings.